

Aumakua (Totems)

The Menehune have established close ties with the spirits of plants and minerals who inhabit the Hawai'ian Islands. It is their relationship with these spirits that allows them to step into the spirit realm. The totem spirits described here should give Storytellers inspiration to create their own spirit totems. Menehune can also choose from some of the Nunnehi totems, including granite and whitewater.

Lava

Background Cost: 4

Flowing lava is the creation of the world. Islands and whole landmasses are formed as lava rises from the sea floor. One day her substance will become the hard rock of the earth, but for now lava is fluid and mobile, perhaps the only rock totem that understands movement. She is hot, but slow moving and deliberate in her actions. Lava teaches strength through patience.

Traits: Lava grants her children the fantastic ability to transform into molten lava. The change costs the Menehune one Mana point per turn that she maintains the lava form. While molten, she can flow into small spaces and tight cracks, however she is also searingly hot, igniting anything flammable she comes into contact with.

Ban: Lava demands that her children always move forward and never retreat.

Mokihana

Background Cost: 1

The mokihana is a beautiful berried tree that has the fragrant scent of anise. Mokihana berries are used in the traditional Hawai'ian lei. She teaches that there is no need to fear nature and that joy comes from embracing it.

Traits: The Menehune children of mokihana gain an additional dot of Appearance and a dot of Etiquette.

Ban: Mokihana requires her children to protect trees whenever possible.

Sea Turtle

Sea turtles swim the seas, protected by their hard shells. They can swim for days on end, and have little fear but of the largest and most dangerous predators.

Background Cost: 3

Traits: Sea turtle grants his children 1 extra dot of Stamina and 2 dots of Survival.

Ban: Sea turtle demands that his children protect the beaches and the creatures that make their homes there, and to punish any who damage them.

Shark

Shark is the ultimate hunter, vicious and unforgiving to his prey. He is primal, unchanged for millennia.

Background Cost: 3

Traits: Shark grants his children 1 extra dot of Strength and 2 dots of Brawl. However, his children lose 1 dot of Charisma.

Ban: Shark requires his children to defend the seas and to destroy anyone or anything that harms them.

Waterfall

Roaring off a cliff with tremendous power, nothing can stop the terrible force of a waterfall.

Background Cost: 1

Traits: Waterfall grants its children an additional dot of Strength and a dot of Athletics.

Ban: Waterfall requires his children to always be on the move, to never stop if they can help it, and to always carry through on a task.

Glamour and Banality

The Menehune refer to Glamour as Mana — the life energy that flows through all things — and the Nunnehi call it Medicine. They do not gather Glamour in the same way as Kithain. Instead, they draw Mana or Medicine directly from the natural world. Because of their close ties to nature, starting Nunnehi and Menehune characters begin with an additional dot of Medicine/Mana. They are also more susceptible to the ravages of Banality. When in a location that has a Banality rating of 7 or higher (see The Gauntlet sidebar, p. 420) the difficulty to enchant others is increased by one. Also, for every night a Menehune or Nunnehi sleeps in a place with a Banality rating of 8 or higher he gains 1 point of Banality.

For clarity's sake, Mana and Medicine are referred to as Glamour for the rest of this section. Also, Nunnehi and Menehune are referred to as tribal fae. This is not intended to diminish either, but only to make the text clearer.

Gathering Medicine

Since they are severed from the Dreaming, tribal fae are unable to gather Glamour from human creativity. Instead they draw Glamour directly from the natural world. The character's current Legacy determines the manner in which she gathers Glamour. Feast/Summer people gather Glamour from natural places such as trees, rock formations, volcanoes, and waterfalls, while War/Winter people get their Glamour from hunting and killing animals and fish. All tribal fae may Harvest Glamour from a source of pure water. Additionally, ali'i may gather Glamour from the bones or physical remains of dead chieftains or other powerful people (this could include movie stars, celebrities, or politicians). The bones continue to provide Glamour so long as they are ritually kept and not seen by mortal eyes or touched by mortal hands.

The Menehune and Nunnehi have three means of gaining Glamour: Harvesting, Raiding, and Blessing.

Harvesting

This slow and careful method of gathering Glamour is the tribal fae's equivalent of Reverie. Harvesting can only be performed in a place of natural beauty: A forest glade, a meadow of flowers, and ancient oak, or a babbling brook are